

Have you ever fantasised about having sex with anyone from the following age groups?

		Male	Female	
Less than 18	9	15	2	
18-21	34	48	19	
21-29	45	50	39	Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.
30-40	24	22	27	
40-50	10	6	14	

Do you think people from a particular community are sexually attractive?

YES 22

Male 33, Female 11

NO 77

Male 67, Female 87

Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

While 58 per cent men in Chennai find a particular caste sexually attractive, only 7 per cent women think so.

Which community do you think is particularly sexually attractive?

Muslim 17

Punjabi 12

Hindu 8

Brahmin 7

Sikh 4

For 1,163 respondents of the total 5,371 who think that a particular caste is sexually attractive. Figures don't add up to 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

Have you ever fantasised about a village man or a woman?

YES 30

Male 45, Female 14

NO 68

Male 54, Female 83

Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.



Location: THE PARK, NEW DELHI

15 PER CENT OF MEN IN JAIPUR HAVE ADMITTED TO HAVING SEX WITH A FRIEND'S WIFE, WHILE 11 PER CENT OF MEN IN CHENNAI HAVE HAD SEX WITH THEIR DOMESTICS.

fantasies. In contrast only 35 per cent of men (60 per cent in Jaipur) claimed not wanting to do so. So many of us don't actually want to act on our fantasies—why censor them then? Are the Orwellian thought-police irretrievably inside our heads? Have we become the irrevocably Foucauldian docile bodies inhabited by disciplined minds? What stops us from fantasising? Perhaps, "I can't be unfaithful to my spouse/partner even in my fantasies" is part of it or "Casual sex is immoral and not to be thought of" or "That would be really stupid. Sex with a stranger? S/he could turn out to be an axe murderer or have a sexually transmitted disease (STD)". These are complex statements that need more nuanced explanations but for the sake of argument it is worth indulging in some simplistic generalisations. The first statement is part of a normative (usually but not exclusively, heterosexual) understanding of sexuality as monogamous. The second is more clearly part of not just a moral code but often a romantic vision of sexuality as engaging deep feelings as well as bodies. The third is often a feminist response based on years of struggle against violence and also part of a new brigade: the safe sex police, a category in which many of us may recognise ourselves.

Anthropologist Carole Vance has famously argued that feminism's success in bringing sexual violence into public also had the unintended consequence of suggesting that women are less sexually safe than ever and that "discussions and explorations of pleasure are better deferred to a safer time". Vance refers to the need to talk of sexual pleasure even as we battle against sexual violence. And one might add, the need to continue to act on our desires even as we protect ourselves from STDs.